

Seawall height in Boynton Beach

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

BOYNTON BEACH • PALM BEACH COUNTY

No minimum set in local code

Boynton Beach's development code requires a permit for seawalls and keeps the water-side face on the property line, but sets no seawall height.

The detail

MINIMUM	None set - LDR Ch. 3 Art. V Sec. 3.O
PLACEMENT	Water-side face may not encroach over the property line; no wall east of the 1956 Lake Worth bulkhead line - Sec. 3.O
RELATED	Lake Worth landfill must be at least 6 ft above mean sea level (fill, not seawall) - Sec. 3.O
PROJECTION	Seawalls/docks may not extend more than 1/4 of waterway width - Sec. 3.O
WHO PERMITS	Seawalls, bulkheads, docks and piers along access waterways are installed under a permit from the Development Department - LDR Ch. 3 Art. V Sec. 3.O
WHERE THE LINE COMES FROM	The Lake Worth bulkhead line was set by Ordinance No. 289 on Map No. R-56-006 (September 1956), ratified in the LDR - Sec. 3.O
SOMEONE ELSE'S WATERWAY	A dock in a waterway owned by a separate property holder needs that owner's written consent before any permit - Sec. 3.O
FIRE RULES FOR DOCKS	Fire protection requirements for docks and piers sit in Code of Ordinances Part II, Ch. 9, Art. II - Sec. 3.O
NEW CANALS	Access waterways built with a development need 6 ft of water over a continuous 20 ft bottom width; where no seawall or bulkhead is required, banks slope at least 4:1 to that depth - LDR Ch. 4 Art. VIII Sec. 3.H.2

Where this comes from: City of Boynton Beach Land Development Regulations, Ch. 3 Zoning, Art. V Supplemental Regulations, Sec. 3.O Seawalls, Bulkheads, Docks, and Piers (Gridics CodeHub); Ch. 4 Art. VIII Sec. 3.H (Canals and Waterways)

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.